

### **overview of research :**

Our research addresses regulatory shortcomings in overseeing drinking water quality in Michigan's public school system, focusing on the Ann Arbor school system. Through our research, we discovered various stakeholders, such as students, administrators, parents, health officials, and legislators, are all uniquely affected by the lack of more tailored regulations on aging infrastructure, insufficient resources provided in regard to water quality and testing in the state and school systems, and limited public awareness of water quality resources and in the state and school systems. Michigan legislation passed the Filter First Legislation in October of 2023, requiring all public schools and daycares in the state of Michigan to have filtered faucet systems and to partake in a water management plan for consistent periodic sampling and testing of water. However, Ignoring the issue may lead to prolonged lead exposure, health implications, legal liabilities, and erosion of public trust which is something we were interested in uncovering.

### **Questions to ask the audience:**

How does the issue of drinking water quality in educational institutions resonate with your personal concerns or experiences?

Kevin on the first mega cluster:

Hi, I'm Kevin. As our team mates mentioned before, we're addressing the significant challenge of water quality in Michigan's educational institutions.

When it comes to the Affinity notes. I'll highlight our findings on Michigan schools' water quality, focusing on the 'Regulatory and Infrastructure Challenges.' This critical area covers two main aspects:

Firstly, we have 'The Influence of Aging Infrastructure on Contamination.' This meta cluster reveals how outdated and deteriorating infrastructure is a primary source of water contamination in schools. It highlights the urgent need for modernizing our water systems to safeguard the health of our students.

Secondly, 'Evolving Standards and Challenges in Michigan's Water Quality Management' reflects the dynamic nature of this issue. It underscores the necessity for regulatory frameworks to evolve in tandem with emerging challenges in water quality management. This cluster captures the need for adaptive, stringent standards and effective oversight mechanisms.

In conclusion, the clusters reveal the need for sweeping reforms in both infrastructure and regulations, aligning with our goal to ensure safe drinking water in educational institutions. It's clear that addressing these challenges is crucial for the health and safety of our students.

Now, I'll pass the Jordan, who will discuss the second Mega-Mega Cluster, "State-School Synergy for Water Safety":